

Azure pricing and AKS costs

-Azure free account and pricing options-

- **Azure free account provides**
 - \$200 credit for the first 30 days
 - 12 months for free for some Azure products
 - Always free option for specific Azure products, including AKS (includes limitations)

Azure service	Description	Type	Free monthly amount	Free period
 Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)	Deploy and manage containers using the tools you choose.	Compute	Free	Always

Reference: <https://azure.microsoft.com/en-us/free/free-account-faq/>

- If you don't have an Azure account, I would strongly advice you to go for the free option and practice with me throughout this course for a more efficient learning experience
- **Azure pricing options:**
 - Pay-as-you-go: default plan; standard price (highest)
 - Reserved instances:
 - 1 year reserved: 48% saving from the pay-as-you-go price
 - 3 years reserved: 65% saving from the pay-as-you-go price
 - Spot instances:
 - No SLA or guarantee thus, not recommended for production
 - 90% saving from the pay-as-you-go price
 - The price depends on the region

Azure pricing and AKS costs

-AKS cost-

- No cost for management side
- Control plane is hosted on Azure side and free
 - There is the option to opt for a paid control plane tier that is recommended for clusters with more than 10 nodes and provides greater control plane resources, scalability, and a higher SLA. This paid tier is also known as the "standard tier" or "uptime SLA feature."
- You pay for VMs used for worker nodes
- Additionally, you pay for Azure resources used in conjunction with AKS such as:
 - Associated storage
 - Networking resources consumed
 - Other products optionally integrated with the AKS cluster
- Azure provides a pricing calculator that we can use to estimate and simulate the cost for an AKS cluster